



North Ridge Elementary

North Ridge Elementary	Board Report		
	Features: Student Engagement, 2nd Grade GTS, Library, Art <i>Thanks to Heidi Kuberski, Renae Conway, Betsy Bejarno and Amanda Erps for the May content</i>		
ACADEMIC	ACADEMIC SUPPORT	CLIMATE / CULTURE	TEACHER EFFICACY
By May, 2026 the percentage of students scoring "not yet proficient" in math will decrease by 5% from the previous year as measured by the Iowa Statewide Assessment of Student Progress (ISASP) test.	By May, 2026 the percentage of students (Grades K-4) receiving office referrals for physical incidents on the playground will reduce by 5% as compared to the previous school year.	By May, 2026 North Ridge teachers and staff will have communicated positively to each family on at least 4 occasions.	By May, 2026, the percentage of certified staff participating in a coaching cycle related to a building goal will increase by 10% as compared to the previous school year.

Instructional Engagement Highlights from Heidi Kuberski

Over the past several weeks, classroom visits during myView instruction provided an opportunity to observe and celebrate the many engagement strategies being implemented to support student learning across the building.

During these visits, short video clips were captured to highlight the outstanding instruction and learning taking place in classrooms. These videos also serve as a valuable opportunity for staff members to learn from one another and reflect on effective instructional practices. It was exciting to see students actively engaged through collaboration, discussion, movement, and meaningful participation in their learning experiences.

Please take a moment to watch the following video: [10 Seconds of Success: Engagement in Action](#)

North Ridge Elementary students continue to engage in meaningful learning experiences that promote creativity, collaboration, communication, and critical thinking across multiple content areas.



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2nd Grade GTS – STEM Occupation Interviews

Second Grade GTS students recently completed an in-depth STEM occupations unit that culminated in recorded career interviews. Throughout the unit, students explored a variety of STEM careers including pharmacists, air traffic controllers, architects, and engineers. Students read informational texts, practiced comprehension skills through high-level written responses, and collaboratively developed interview questions connected to each profession. The unit also included a guest pharmacist visit, providing students with an authentic opportunity to apply their questioning and listening skills.

Students then partnered together to research a STEM occupation of their choice. Research topics included job responsibilities, problems solved within the profession, necessary skills, workplace settings, the importance of the occupation, and required education or training. Each pair developed interview questions and practiced their responses before recording their final interviews. Students demonstrated strong communication skills and deep understanding as they used their research to provide thoughtful and detailed responses during the interviews.

Library News

Students across all grade levels participated in engaging literacy experiences throughout the month in the North Ridge Library.

- Kindergarten students explored stories by authors Mac Barnett and John Klassen, focusing on using illustrations and story clues to deepen comprehension.
- First grade students read books by Ryan T. Higgins and explored “wordless” books, using illustrations to tell stories and inspire their own creative chalk drawings outdoors.
- Second grade students studied Tall Tales and practiced identifying exaggeration in stories featuring characters such as Paul Bunyan, Pecos Bill, and John Henry. Students also enjoyed the interactive story *Cloudy with a Chance of Meatballs*.
- Third grade students participated in a “Book Tasting,” exploring a variety of genres and identifying books they may want to check out in the future.
- Fourth grade students learned about famous inventions such as the Slinky and Super Soaker Water Gun while discussing how mistakes and experimentation often lead to innovation.



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News from the Art Room

North Ridge students continue to showcase creativity and artistic growth through a variety of hands-on art projects.

- Kindergarten students created dinosaur-themed artwork inspired by *If the Dinosaurs Came Back*, focusing on contrast and detailed backgrounds.
- First grade students completed clay animal pinch pots and are preparing to glaze their creations before final kiln firing.
- Second grade students designed personalized clay tiles while learning slab rolling and coil-building techniques. Students will soon add color using oil pastels and tempera cakes.
- Third grade students demonstrated perseverance and craftsmanship while weaving yarn houses on cardboard looms.
- Fourth grade students are completing clay loom projects with woven yarn centers and will soon begin parody drawings inspired by Grant Wood's *American Gothic*.

These experiences continue to provide students with opportunities to build creativity, collaboration, problem-solving, and communication skills while fostering excitement for learning across content areas.